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THREE DAYS AFTER we returned from Geneva, George Shultz said again that he wanted to resign; he was just burned out from the intensity of the job, and I suppose he may have been growing tired of his differences with Cap Weinberger. As I had previously, I said I wanted him to remain as long as I was in the White House but I wouldn't try to talk him out of leaving. Once again, George proved himself a patriot: Rather than leave just as we were getting ready to press forward to continue the momentum begun at Geneva, he said he would remain on the job, and during the next three years he proved again and again that he was one of the finest and most distinguished secretaries of state in the history of our country.

A week after we returned from Geneva, I sent a handwritten letter to Gorbachev in which I tried to continue the process begun at the fireside summit and to overcome his resistance to the Strategic Defense Initiative:

Dear General Secretary Gorbachev:

> Now that we are both home and facing the task of leading our countries into a more constructive relationship with each other, I wanted to waste no time in giving you some of my initial thoughts on our meetings. Though I will be sending shortly, in a more formal and official manner, a more detailed commentary on our discussions, there are some things I would like to convey very personally and very privately.